

NORTH CAROLINA OWNER-BUILDER PERMIT KIT

Qualify for the exemption · File the permit · Pass the inspections

Project Address: _____

County: _____

Owner-Builder: _____

Permit Application Date: _____

Every North Carolina statute, threshold, and requirement in this kit
is cited on the page it appears on — verified August 2026.

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How to Use This Kit

Five working documents that take a North Carolina owner-builder from "am I allowed to do this?" to a certificate of compliance.

North Carolina is one of the better states to build your own home in: the law is written in your favor and the building code is statewide. What trips owner-builders up is that **permits are administered by 100 counties and dozens of municipalities**, each with its own forms and portal. This kit separates the two — what the State requires, fixed and cited here, and what your jurisdiction requires, which you fill in.

WHAT IS IN THE KIT

The five documents

	Document	What it does for you
NC.1	Owner-Builder Exemption Walkthrough	Whether you qualify, what you swear to, and what takes the exemption away. Read this first.
NC.2	Permit Application Checklist	What to gather and verify before you file — zoning, septic and well, driveway, erosion control, energy code.
NC.3	Inspection Sequence	The order inspections happen in, what each one checks, and fields for dates and results.
NC.4	Where to File Directory	Your county's offices, numbers, and portals — and how to find each one.
NC.5	Forms & Documents Index	Each document you will meet: what it is, when, and from where.

HOW TO USE IT

- **Start with NC.1.** If you do not qualify for the exemption, nothing else in the kit matters yet.
- **Fill in NC.4 before you need it.** Ten minutes of phone calls early saves a week of chasing later.
- **Work NC.2 with a pen** and do not file until the boxes are checked. Incomplete applications are the most common cause of delay.
- **Keep NC.3 on the job** and record every inspection date and result as it happens.

How these facts were checked — and what this is not

Every North Carolina claim here was read against its primary source in August 2026 and is cited where it appears; where counties differ the kit says so and gives the verification step. This is a process reference, not legal advice, and does not replace your inspections department or the State Building Code. North Carolina moved the contractor threshold as recently as 2023 — confirm anything you rely on.